P 10-12

ACCREDITATION / GLP COMPLIANCE CERTIFICATE AND SCOPE OF ACCREDITATION

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1. Purpose and Scope

The purpose of this document is to define the format of the Accreditation Certificate and Scope of Accreditation (C&SoA) issued to accredited Conformity Assessment Bodies (CAB's) and the associated conditions for its use. This document is applicable to all divisions of SANAS.

Where reference to "Accreditation" has been made, this includes GLP/GCP Compliance.

2. Definitions and References

SANAS PM 01 SANAS Policy Manual
SANAS A 01 References, Acronyms and Definitions

Accreditation for Conformity Assessment, Calibration and Good Laboratory Practice Act, Act No 19 of 2006.

3. The SANAS Accreditation Certificate

3.1 Drafting of the Certificate and Scope of Accreditation

3.1.1 On receipt of an application for accreditation, the Accreditation Manager reviews the scope of accreditation to determine if SANAS has the required resources and competencies in order to accredit the scope applied for.

3.1.2 The 1st draft Scope of Accreditation will be drafted during the application stage for accreditation, and prior to the initial assessment.

3.1.3 The Assessment Specialist / Team Leader shall ensure that the 1st draft of the Scope of Accreditation is verified on site during the initial assessment by the Nominated Representative. Signature by both the Assessment Specialist / Team Leader and Nominated Representative on the draft Scope will be required as an indication that the 1st draft of the Scope of accreditation is accepted.

3.1.4 The Approval Committee's (AC) role is to verify that the scope of accreditation applied for has been assessed on site and found to comply with all the accreditation requirements. The AC will approve the draft Scope of accreditation.

3.1.5 Once the decision on accreditation has been made, the relevant SANAS administrator shall update / amend the Certificate and Scope of Accreditation as required, as per the procedure defined in OP19 "SANAS Administration Processes".

3.2 Certificate Endorsement

3.2.1 The SANAS Accreditation certificate bears the formal accreditation status of an accredited CAB. The Accreditation Certificate consist of two parts namely the Certificate and the Scope of accreditation.

3.2.2 The SANAS Chief Executive Officer (CEO) shall sign the certificate after the relevant Accreditation Manager has signed the Scope of accreditation section of the certificate.

3.2.3 SANAS may authorise an employee of SANAS to certify a copy of an accreditation certificate as being a true copy of the original certificate.

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In any legal proceedings, a document that purports to be a certificate, issued either as the original or certified copy, is upon its production evidence of the facts contained therein.

3.2.4 A SANAS accreditation certificate is the property of SANAS and must be returned by a CAB when requested by SANAS to do so.

3.3 Issuing of SANAS Certificates

3.3.1 SANAS shall issue an Accreditation Certificate to each CAB to which it grants accreditation, and for each main accreditation / management system / standard granted.

3.3.2 Additional copies may be issued, subject to the payment of a fee as detailed in the Fees Document P 14.

3.4 Validity period of the Accreditation Certificate

3.4.1 Unless prescribed by a regulation or other legal instrument, the validity period for SANAS's certificates shall be as follows:

Programme	**Validity period**
Calibration and Testing Laboratories	5 years
Certification Bodies	3 Years
Inspection Bodies	4 Years
Verification / Repair Bodies	4 Years
Medical Laboratories	4 Years
GLP/GCP facilities	5 years
Reference Material Producers	5 years
Blood Transfusion laboratories, donor clinics and blood banks	4 years
Proficiency Testing Providers	4 years
Broad Based Black Economic Empowerment (B-BBEE) Rating Agencies	4 years

3.4.2 Certificates shall be re-issued following a successful re-assessment of the CAB, and/or where any amendments to the content of the certificate is required (refer to clause 3.5.1).

On re-issue of a new version of the certificate, the facility shall ensure that the previous obsolete version of their certificate is destroyed or returned to SANAS when requested to do so.

3.4.3 The P37 "Management of Extraordinary Events or Circumstances and Conditions for Terminating Assessments" allows SANAS to extend the expiry date of an accreditation for not more than 6 months past the expiry date under certain circumstances as provided for in the P37 document. The extension of the expiry date of accreditation shall not affect the original cycle of accreditation.

3.4.4 Notwithstanding the above, the Accreditation Certificate can be withdrawn at any time for transgressions of the SANAS Terms and Conditions of Accreditation (F147 / F199).

3.5 Content of the Accreditation Certificate

3.5.1 Each Accreditation Certificate shall contain:

i) the identification and logo of SANAS;

ii) the full name and location of the accredited CAB;
iii) the company registration number of the accredited CAB, where applicable;
iv) all locations from which one or more activities are performed and which are covered by SANAS accreditation;
v) the unique SANAS accreditation number;
vi) the effective date* of granting or renewing accreditation and the expiry* date;
vii) a description of the main accreditation;
viii) the stated management system the body complies with;
ix) a statement of conformity and reference to the standard, or other normative document(s);
x) Reference to the Accreditation for Conformity Assessment, Calibration and Good Laboratory Practice Act, Act No 19 of 2006 (where the accredited CAB is based in South Africa); and
xi) The scope of accreditation granted.

Refer to 3.6 "Effective and Expiry Dates of Accreditation

3.5.2 The scope of accreditation granted shall include as appropriate:

3.5.2.1 The "Issue date" which shall be the date of a request to amend the scope of accreditation, or the AC/AM decision, as appropriate. The issue date shall not be earlier than the effective date of accreditation (Refer to Clause 3.6)

3.5.2.2 *for Certification Bodies:*
i) the type of certification (e.g. management systems, products, processes, services or persons);
ii) the Certification scheme(s);
ii) the standards, normative documents and/or regulatory requirements, to which management systems, products, processes, and services, or persons are certified as applicable (i.e. Level 3, 4 and 5 normative documents);
iii) industry sectors, where relevant;
iv) product, processes, services and persons categories where relevant.

3.5.2.3 *for Inspection Bodies:*
i) the type of inspection body (as defined in ISO/IEC 17020);
ii) Inspection schemes, where relevant;
iii) the field and range of inspection for which accreditation has been granted;
iv) the regulations, inspection methods, standards and/or specifications containing the requirements against which the inspection is to be performed, as applicable.

3.5.2.4 *for Calibration Laboratories:*
i) the calibration and measurement capability (CMC) expressed in terms of:
- Measurand or reference material;
- Calibration or measurement method or procedure and type of instrument or material to be calibrated or measured;
- Measurement range and additional parameters where applicable, e.g. frequency of applied voltage; and
- Measurement uncertainty.

3.5.2.5 *for Testing and Medical Laboratories, and Blood Transfusion facilities:*
i) The materials or products tested;
ii) The component, parameter or characteristic tested;

iii) The test or types of test performed and, where appropriate, the techniques, methods and/or equipment used.

3.5.2.6 for Verification / Repair Bodies:

i) the type of verification / repair body;
ii) the field and range of verification / repair for which accreditation has been granted, e.g. mass / volume / length;
iii) the standards, normative documents and/or regulatory requirements containing the requirements against which the verification / repair is to be performed, as applicable;
iv) verification / repair scheme and process, where relevant;
v) industry sector, where relevant.

3.5.2.7 for Proficiency Testing Providers:

i) schemes that the proficiency testing provider is competent to provide;
ii) type of proficiency testing items;
iii) the measurand(s) or characteristic(s) or where appropriate the type of measurand(s) or characteristic(s) that are to be identified, measured or tested.

3.5.2.8 for Reference material Producers:

i) types of reference materials (certified reference material, reference material or both);
ii) the reference material matrix or artefact;
iii) the property/properties characterized;
iv) the approach used to assign property values.

3.5.2.9 for validation and verification bodies:

i) identification of the activity (validation or verification or both);
ii) the standards, normative documents and/or regulatory requirements to which validation or verification or both is to be performed, as applicable;
iii) validation and/or verification scheme, where relevant;
iv) industry sector, where relevant.

3.5.1.10 for B-BBEE Rating Agencies:

i) the specific conformity assessment activities the conformity assessment body is accredited for;
ii) Codes of Good Practice on Black Economic Empowerment;
iii) B-BBEE Verification Manual;
iv) industry sector codes, where relevant.

3.5.2.11 for GLP / GCP compliant facilities:

i) the areas of expertise of the facility, in line with the OECD GLP guidelines or VICH GCP guidelines, as applicable.

3.5.3 In the case where an Accreditation / Certificate needs to be amended, SANAS shall determine what, if any, assessment procedure is appropriate and shall act accordingly.

3.6 Effective and Expiry Dates of Accreditation

3.6.1 Initial Accreditation

3.6.1.1 The effective date of accreditation is the date that accreditation has been granted by SANAS. (Refer to SANAS P 20 “The responsibilities and duties of the Approval Committees and Accreditation Managers in the approval and decision on accreditation.”)

3.6.1.2 The date of expiry is calculated from the effective date of accreditation, for the number of years of the relevant accreditation cycle, minus 1 day:
E.g. For a 5-year accreditation cycle: 1 May 2015 to 30 April 2020

Note: The AM may decide to align the expiry dates of accreditation of CABs in a group / region, depending on proximity of the CAB, to allow for assessments and re-assessments to take place at the same time thus saving on costs and resources. This will be done in agreement of the CAB, and subject to the expiry date not going beyond the original expiry date. (E.g. 2 CAB's in Uganda with different expiry dates can be aligned, to allow a team to go and conduct a re-assessment at the same time).

3.6.1.3 Where the expiry of accreditation is extended (ref. clause 3.4.3), the certificate and scope of accreditation shall be issued with the new date of expiry, which shall not exceed 6 months from the original expiry date. The effective date (clause 3.6.1.1) shall remain unchanged. The expiration of the renewed accreditation shall be based on the original re-accreditation cycle.

3.6.2 Renewal of Accreditation

3.6.2.1 Accreditation Managers shall ensure, as far as possible, that the decision-making process takes place before the certificate expiry date. The effective date for the renewal of accreditation shall then be the day after the current expiry date.
E.g. Previous cycle: 1 May 2010 to 30 April 2015
Next cycle: 1 May 2015 to 30 April 2020

3.6.2.2 Should circumstances beyond the control of SANAS cause the decision-making process to take place after the certificate expiry date, then the effective date for the renewal of accreditation shall only be the day of the decision to renew accreditation (i.e. the date of the Approval Committee decision).

3.6.2.3 In the case of clause 3.6.2.2, the date of expiry shall follow the original cycle.

3.6.2.4 Where the delay in the decision-making process is due to circumstances being beyond the control of the CAB, the Accreditation Manager shall consider the circumstances and use his/her discretion as to the effective date (i.e. whether it should be the date after the expiry date, or the date of the decision to renew accreditation.) All such decisions must be recorded in writing and appropriately filed.

3.6.3 Extension of the Scope of Accreditation

Where a certificate has been updated to include an extension of scope that has been granted by SANAS, the following shall apply:

i) If the scope was extended at a surveillance or additional assessment, the effective and expiry dates of accreditation will remain unchanged, with only a new issue of the scope of accreditation being issued (refer to clause 3.5.2.1).

ii) If the scope was extended at the re-assessment, with the decision-making date prior to the expiry date, depending on the urgency of the scope being reflected on the certificate and scope of accreditation, the Accreditation Manager can use his/her discretion to issue the certificate and scope of accreditation on the earlier decision-making date, or the date after the expiry date. In either case, the expiry shall be calculated as per clause 3.6.1.2.

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3.7 Use of the Accreditation Certificate

The use of SANAS accreditation certificates shall be in accordance with the SANAS Terms and Conditions (F147 / F199) for Accreditation and R 04 “Conditions for use of accreditation symbols, reference to accreditation and combined marks”.

4. Publication of Accreditation Status

4.1 A list of all SANAS accredited CAB’s is maintained on the SANAS website at www.sanas.co.za.

4.2 SANAS shall publish the current valid Certificate and Scope of Accreditation of each accredited CAB on its website.

4.3 Where accreditation of a CAB has been suspended, withdrawn or expired, the Certificate and Scope of Accreditation shall be removed from the website, and the status updated accordingly, as either “Suspended”, “Withdrawn” or ”Expired”, with the applicable dates and scopes affected.

4.4 A CAB’s withdrawal / expired status shall be reflected on the SANAS website for a period of 3 months, after which all reference to the CAB will be removed.

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ADDENDUM 2: Amendment Record: P10-12

Proposed By:	Section	Change
AM	3.4.1	Accreditation cycle for GLP/GCP facilities changed from 2 to 5 years
AM	3.4.2 Par 2	Added "or returned to SANAS when requested to do so."
QM	3.4.3	Clause added
AM	3.5.1 (iii)	Added "where applicable"
QM	3.6.1.3	Clause added
QM	3.6.2.4	Added "All such decisions must be recorded in writing and appropriately filed."
QM	4.3	Added "or expired"